SIGHT AFRICA · STRATEGIC OPERATING SYSTEM

# AFRICA FINTECH JOURNAL

Independent media + research on fintech, Bitcoin, AI, startups and cyber

*Execution starts 1 January 2027 · 2026 is a preparation year outside the agenda · All amounts in FBU*

## 1. What we expect from this product

AFJ is expected to own the narrative and the data of the African digital economy. It buys attention and credibility that no advertising budget could buy, and monetises them through research, events and institutional subscriptions.

- Become the reference publication of francophone African fintech.
- Build proprietary datasets (operators, volumes, regulation) nobody else has.
- Convert audience into institutional research revenue at high margin.
- 1M+ professional audience and 600 M FBU revenue by 2036.

## 2. Economic model

| Revenue line | Mechanism | Target margin |
|---|---|---|
| Sponsorship | Newsletter and report sponsors | 65% |
| Premium research | Annual institutional subscription | 80% |
| Events & summit | Tickets + partner packages | 45% |
| Research-as-a-service | Custom studies for banks, DFIs, regulators | 60% |
| Indices & benchmarks | Licensed data products | 85% |

## 3. Investment required

| Phase | Window | Capital needed | Main use |
|---|---|---|---|
| Preparation | 2026 | 8 M FBU | Editorial charter, brand, first datasets |
| Launch | 2027 | 45 M FBU | 2 journalists, CMS, distribution |
| Scale | 2028–2030 | 260 M FBU | Research desk, annual summit |
| Institution | 2031–2036 | 900 M FBU | Data platform, regional bureaus |

## 4. Feasibility assessment

| Dimension | Assessment | Condition to satisfy |
|---|---|---|
| Technical | Very high | Headless CMS + email deliverability |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Regulatory | High | Press registration, right-of-reply discipline |
| Operational | Medium | Sustained editorial cadence without quality loss |
| Financial | Medium | Sponsorship concentration must stay < 25% per client |
| Talent | Medium | Editor-in-chief with regional credibility |

## 5. Technology & operating stack

- Headless CMS + CDN, newsletter infrastructure with strong deliverability.
- Structured research database (operators, funding, regulation, volumes).
- AI editorial copilots for translation and data extraction — never for bylines.
- Paywall and entitlements settled through BitLibera.

## 6. Key performance indicators

| Metric | 2027 | 2031 | 2036 |
|---|---|---|---|
| Subscribers | 25 000 | 250 000 | 1 000 000 |
| Paying institutions | 5 | 60 | 300 |
| Revenue | 6 M FBU | 150 M FBU | 600 M FBU |
| Editorial output / month | 12 pieces | 40 pieces | 80 pieces |

## 7. Risks & mitigations

| Risk | Impact | Mitigation |
|---|---|---|
| Independence vs. monetisation | Critical | Published editorial charter, separate commercial team |
| AI-generated content commoditisation | High | Proprietary data + on-the-ground reporting |
| Ad revenue volatility | Medium | Shift mix toward subscriptions and research |
| Legal exposure | Medium | Pre-publication legal review on sensitive pieces |

## 8. Ten-year trajectory

### TODAY

| Dimension | Detail |
|---|---|
| Users | Pre-launch / early readership |
| Revenue | 0 |

| | |
|---|---|
| Features | Editorial pipeline · Newsletter |
| Market position | Niche regional fintech voice |
| Risks | Editorial quality |
| Advantage | First-mover, founder credibility |
| Stack | Ghost/Notion + CDN |
| Team | 3 |

## 1 YEAR

| Dimension | Detail |
|---|---|
| Users | 25k subscribers |
| Revenue | 6M FBU (sponsorship + events) |
| Features | Weekly newsletter · Quarterly reports |
| Market position | Reference fintech publication in francophone Africa |
| Risks | Ad revenue volatility |
| Advantage | Trusted independent voice |
| Stack | Headless CMS |
| Team | 8 |

## 5 YEARS

| Dimension | Detail |
|---|---|
| Users | 250k subscribers, 1M readers |
| Revenue | 150M FBU (research + events + sponsorship) |
| Features | Premium research · Industry awards · Annual summit |
| Market position | African fintech category-defining media |
| Risks | Independence vs. monetization |
| Advantage | Owned audience + data |
| Stack | Custom publishing platform |
| Team | 45 |

## 10 YEARS

| Dimension | Detail |
|---|---|
| Users | 1M+ professional audience |
| Revenue | 600M FBU |

| | |
|---|---|
| Features | Research-as-a-service · Indices & benchmarks |
| Market position | Standard reference for African digital economy |
| Risks | Disruption from AI-generated content |
| Advantage | Proprietary data + relationships |
| Stack | Data products + AI publishing |
| Team | 180 |

## MATURE

| Dimension | Detail |
|---|---|
| Users | Institutional clients (banks, DFIs, regulators) |
| Revenue | High-margin recurring |
| Features | Africa Fintech Index · Policy advisory |
| Market position | Equivalent of FT/Stratechery for African digital economy |
| Risks | Trust capital |
| Advantage | Editorial independence + data moat |
| Stack | Internal AI editorial copilots |
| Team | Standalone media subsidiary |